# Paragraphs: Group Related Ideas

Australian Curriculum v9.0 · Year 4 English
(Year 3 review skill)
AC9E3LA04

🎒 Back to School 2027 Warm-Up

Name: _____ Date: _____

## LEARNING INTENTION

I can group related sentences into paragraphs and know when to start a new paragraph.

## I CAN…

- ✔ group sentences about one main idea
- ✔ spot a sentence that does not belong
- ✔ start a new paragraph at the right time

## KEY STRATEGY AND WORKED EXAMPLE

A **paragraph** is a group of sentences about **one main idea**. Start a new paragraph on a new line when the idea changes. Remember **TiPToP**:

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Ti Time changes | P Place changes | To Topic changes | P Person speaking changes |

## A. TRY TOGETHER – USE THE STRATEGY

1. **Which sentence does not belong** in this paragraph?

> Kookaburras are the largest members of the kingfisher family. They have a loud call that sounds like laughter. Our school canteen sells delicious sausage rolls. They often sit on branches and watch for insects.

2. **What is the main idea** of this paragraph?

> A platypus hunts underwater with its eyes, ears and nostrils closed. It finds food by sensing tiny electric signals from shrimp and worms. It sweeps its bill from side to side as it swims.

☐ Where a platypus sleeps ☐ How a platypus finds food ☐ Why platypuses lay eggs

## B. CORE PRACTICE – SHOW YOUR THINKING

3. **Mark with // where a new paragraph should begin**, then name the TiPToP reason.

> Last Saturday, our class went to the beach. We collected shells and built a huge sandcastle. After lunch, we went for a swim in the shallows. The next morning, I woke up early. I could not wait to tell Nan about our trip. I rang her before breakfast.

## B. CORE PRACTICE (CONTINUED)

4 **Sort these sentences into 2 paragraphs.** Write the letters.

A. Koalas live in eucalypt forests along the east coast of Australia.
B. A koala eats mostly eucalyptus leaves.
C. They sleep in the forks of tall gum trees.
D. These leaves are tough, so koalas rest a lot to save energy.
E. You can also find koalas in parts of South Australia.
F. Koalas prefer only a few kinds of eucalyptus trees.

| Paragraph 1: Where koalas live | Paragraph 2: What koalas eat |
|---|---|
| | |

5 **Write a topic sentence** for this paragraph: _____. Kookaburras eat insects, worms and small lizards. They also eat snakes. They swoop down from a branch to catch their food.

_____

## C. CHALLENGE – REASON AND EXPLAIN

6 **Why start a new paragraph?** Write Time, Place, Topic or Person for each pair.

- We packed our bags and left at dawn. Later that evening, we reached the campsite. _____
- The kitchen smelled of baking. Outside, the garden was quiet. _____
- Rainforests are home to many frogs. Deserts have very different animals. _____
- "Where are we going?" asked Tom. "To the park," said Mia. _____

7 Ravi says, "Every new sentence should start a new paragraph." Is he right? Explain.

_____

_____

8 Write a **two-paragraph recount** called "My First Week of Term 1" (about 6 sentences). Use TiPToP to decide where the new paragraph starts. Leave a line gap between paragraphs.

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

**Watch Out!** One idea per paragraph. If a sentence is about something different, it belongs in another paragraph, or not in the text at all.

💡 **Parent Tip:** Look at a page of a favourite book together. Count the paragraphs and ask: "What is each paragraph mostly about?" Notice where the author started a new one.

🎯 My Term 1 Goal: This term I want to get better at _____

# Answer and Teacher Page

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## ANSWERS

**1.** "Our school canteen sells delicious sausage rolls." It is not about kookaburras.

**2.** How a platypus finds food.

**3.** New paragraph before "The next morning…" Reason: Time (the next morning).

**4.** Paragraph 1 (where koalas live): A, C, E. Paragraph 2 (what koalas eat): B, D, F.

**5.** Sample: Kookaburras eat a wide range of food. Accept any sentence that covers insects, worms, lizards and snakes.

**6.** Time, Place, Topic, Person.

**7.** No. A paragraph groups several sentences about one idea. A new paragraph starts only when the time, place, topic or person speaking changes.

**8.** Open response. See checklist below.

## TEACHER NOTES

**Marking checklist for Q8:** two clear paragraphs • each paragraph has one main idea • the new paragraph starts for a TiPToP reason (for example Monday–Wednesday, then Thursday–Friday) • a line gap or indent between paragraphs • capital letters and full stops.
**Common errors:** starting a new paragraph for every sentence, or writing one long block. Ask students to underline the main idea in each paragraph.
**Support:** colour-code sentences by idea before sorting them into paragraphs.
**Australian Curriculum v9.0:** AC9E3LA04 (Year 3 review): understand that paragraphs are a key organisational feature of the stages of written texts, grouping related information together.